

Wil Cleaveland

Direct-Response Marketer & Copywriter | Remote (Roanoke, VA)

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SUMMARY

Direct-response copywriter and marketer with 10+ years driving \$10M+ in tracked sales funnel revenue across DTC ecommerce, SAAS B2B/B2G, and direct-response/info products. Specialist in email, SMS, list management, and CRO — equally comfortable shipping daily campaigns that hit \$50k/week, ramping into technical specialist markets where buyer skepticism kills generic copy, and directing AI to ship production marketing infrastructure. Built and led copy teams of up to 8.

SKILLS

Direct-response copywriting · Email & SMS marketing · List management & deliverability · Conversion rate optimization (CRO) · Sales funnel copy · Lifecycle automation · Sales enablement & B2B/SAAS content · Offer construction · Team leadership

AI-augmented operations: Direct production-grade Python tooling via AI pair-programming — campaign authoring/QA system that pushes to Maropost, automated daily hard-bounce suppression, click-tracking slug infrastructure, and cross-platform API integrations (Maropost ⇌ Konnektive ⇌ Ottertext). Use AI as a force multiplier across daily campaign work — not as a draft-only tool.

Stack: Maropost · Attentive · Shopify · GoHighLevel · Claude / Claude Code · Python (AI-paired) · Adobe Creative Suite

EXPERIENCE

List Manager & CRO Specialist — Patriot Training Center

Jul 2025 – Present

- Direct-response marketing for a \$5M+/yr firearms-niche brand — owning email, SMS, funnel optimization, list hygiene, and CRO.
- Manage email + SMS promotional calendars across both internal and affiliate offers; reduce Maropost ESP costs via in-depth list hygiene.
- Built and operate AI-augmented Python tooling for the email program: Maropost campaign authoring/QA pipeline with dry-run + execute modes, automated daily hard-bounce suppression, click-tracking slug infrastructure on a custom redirect domain, and Maropost ⇌ Konnektive ⇌ Ottertext API integration work — directing Claude as pair-programmer.
- Engineer GoHighLevel automation workflows for inbound campaigns; optimize landing pages and funnels for cold traffic alongside business founder.

Chief Copywriter & Internal Media Manager — Sicuro Brands

Jul 2020 – Jul 2025

- Owned all messaging and copy for three DTC ecommerce brands (VNSH Holster, Pain Safari, Modern Needs Survival).
- \$10M+ in lifetime sales funnel revenue — VSLs, advertorials, order forms, upsells, downsells.
- Maintained \$50k+/week sustained email revenue from daily campaigns across brand lists.
- Launched and scaled SMS program from zero to \$20k+/week in revenue.
- Ran CRO across funnels to elevate AOV and maintain profitability on cold traffic; analyzed COGS to construct new offers.

SAAS Marketing Writer — Nicus Software

Feb 2019 – Jun 2020

- Built the company's #1 gated lead-gen asset by total leads (ITFM/TBM Maturity Guide) for CIOs, CFOs, and IT Finance leaders at Fortune 500 and government agencies.
- Authored four published customer case studies (Visa, City of Seattle, American Family, State Agency) via direct conferral with customer leadership.
- Maintained sales enablement collateral and authored BDR outreach scripts actively used and iterated by the sales team.

Direct-Response Copywriter — Independent Consultant

Apr 2016 – Feb 2019

- Scaled email revenue to \$300k/month for a survival/tactical client as copy team chief and list manager.
- Wrote lead-gen advertorials for financial DR client competing against Lending Tree and Eloan; consulted with biz-op direct-response businesses on internal list revenue.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts, Communication Studies — Roanoke College

2013